

A SOMATIC GUIDE

# Where Emotions Live in Your Body

+ *The 5-Minute Reset*

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*Your Mind, Body & God*

# Your Body Knows Before Your Mind Does

You've felt it — the tightness in your chest before a difficult conversation. The pit in your stomach when something's wrong. The tension in your shoulders you can't seem to release.

That's not random. That's your body speaking.

Emotions aren't just feelings — they're physical events. They live in your tissues, your muscles, your nervous system. And when you don't process them, they don't disappear. They accumulate.

*The body keeps the score. It always tells the truth — even when the mind tries to lie.*

This guide will teach you two things:

## PART ONE: THE BODY MAP

Learn where different emotions typically live in your body — and how to read your own signals.

## PART TWO: THE 5-MINUTE RESET

A simple daily practice to clear emotional residue and return to zero — that calm, clear, grounded state where you're not carrying anything.

This isn't about suppressing emotions or "staying positive." It's about *feeling* what's there so it can move through you — instead of getting stuck.

Let's begin with the map.

# The Somatic Body Map

Different emotions tend to settle in different areas of the body. This isn't mystical — it's physiological. Your nervous system routes emotional energy through specific pathways.

| Body Area              | Common Emotions Stored                     | Physical Signals                     |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Head / Temples         | Overthinking, worry, mental overload       | Headaches, pressure, foggy thinking  |
| Jaw / Face             | Anger held back, things unsaid             | Clenching, TMJ, tight facial muscles |
| Throat                 | Suppressed expression, silenced voice      | Tightness, lump in throat            |
| Shoulders / Neck       | Burden, responsibility, carrying too much  | Tension, stiffness, pain             |
| Chest / Heart          | Grief, heartbreak, love, longing           | Tightness, heaviness, aching         |
| Upper Back             | Feeling unsupported, betrayal              | Tension between shoulder blades      |
| Stomach / Solar Plexus | Anxiety, fear, powerlessness               | Butterflies, nausea, pit in stomach  |
| Lower Belly            | Shame, sexuality, creativity blocks        | Heaviness, disconnection, numbness   |
| Lower Back             | Financial stress, fear about survival      | Pain, tightness, weakness            |
| Hips                   | Old trauma, things you "sit on"            | Tightness, restricted movement       |
| Legs / Feet            | Feeling ungrounded, fear of moving forward | Restlessness, weakness               |

## IMPORTANT NOTE

This map is a starting point, not a rulebook. **Your body has its own language.** Pay attention to YOUR patterns. Where do YOU feel stress? Sadness? Anger? Joy?

# Your Personal Body Map

Now it's your turn. Think about the last few weeks. Where have you felt tension, discomfort, or holding?  
What emotions might be connected?

## Map Your Patterns

When I'm stressed, I feel it in my:

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What does it feel like? (tight, heavy, hot, numb, etc.)

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When I'm anxious, I feel it in my:

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What does it feel like?

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When I'm sad, I feel it in my:

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What does it feel like?

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When I'm angry, I feel it in my:

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What does it feel like?

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When I'm at peace, I feel it in my:

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What does it feel like?

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### THE BODY-EMOTION CONNECTION

The more you practice noticing where emotions live in YOUR body, the faster you'll catch them — before they become chronic tension, pain, or illness. **Awareness is the first step to clearing.**

# What If I Can't Feel My Body?

If you tried the body map exercise and felt... nothing? You're not broken. You're protected.

Many people have learned to disconnect from their bodies. It's actually a survival skill — if feeling was too painful, your nervous system learned to turn the volume down.

## Why This Happens

- **Trauma** — The body stores what the mind can't process. Disconnection keeps you "safe" from feeling it.
- **Living in your head** — Our culture rewards thinking over feeling. You may have been trained out of body awareness.
- **Overwhelm** — When there's too much to feel, numbness is a protective response.
- **Chronic stress** — Being in fight-or-flight too long disconnects you from subtler sensations.

The good news: Reconnection is possible. The body is patient. It's been waiting for you to come home.

### MY STORY: HOW PILATES BROUGHT ME HOME

I was burned out. Disconnected. I'd spent years as a grief counselor, holding space for everyone else's pain while ignoring my own body's signals. I was pouring from an empty cup — and I couldn't even feel how empty it was.

Then I found Pilates. It wasn't just exercise. It was a conversation with my body. The slow, precise movements forced me to *pay attention*. To notice which muscles were firing. To feel where I was holding.

**Pilates brought me home to myself.** For the first time in years, I could feel my body — not as a burden to manage, but as a partner to listen to. That reconnection changed everything.

# Doorways Back to Your Body

Pilates was my path, but it's not the only one. Here are other ways to rebuild body awareness — choose what resonates with you.

| Practice                                                                    | Why It Works                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Slow, mindful movement<br><small>Pilates, yoga, tai chi, qigong</small>     | Forces attention inward. You can't rush — you have to feel.     |
| Breathwork<br><small>Box breathing, 4-7-8, holotropic</small>               | Breath is the bridge between mind and body. Follow it inward.   |
| Water immersion<br><small>Baths, float tanks, swimming</small>              | Water creates sensation across your whole body. Hard to ignore. |
| Self-massage / touch<br><small>Foam rolling, dry brushing</small>           | Physical touch wakes up nerve endings. Start with pressure.     |
| Temperature contrast<br><small>Cold plunge, sauna, contrast showers</small> | Strong sensation cuts through numbness. You WILL feel this.     |
| Walking barefoot<br><small>Grass, sand, earth</small>                       | Grounds you literally. Feet have thousands of nerve endings.    |

## START WHERE YOU ARE

If you can't feel subtle sensations yet, start with **obvious ones** — temperature, pressure, movement. The subtlety will come. Your body hasn't forgotten how to feel. It's just been protecting you. As you build safety, sensation returns.

## READY FOR THE RESET?

Now that you understand the body map — and have doorways to reconnect if needed — let's learn the daily practice that clears what you're carrying. Turn the page for the 5-Minute Reset.

# The 5-Minute Reset

Here's a simple daily practice to clear what's there, so you don't carry yesterday into today.

*Zero is that clear, calm, grounded state where you're not carrying anything. No resentment. No anxiety. No weight. Just presence.*

This practice takes 5 minutes. Do it every morning, every evening, or anytime you feel yourself accumulating emotional weight.

**5:00**

minutes to reset

## What You'll Need

- A quiet space (or headphones)
- A comfortable seated or lying position
- Permission to feel whatever arises

## The Goal

This isn't meditation. It's not about emptying your mind or achieving bliss. It's about **checking in with your body, acknowledging what's there, and letting it move** — so you return to zero.

### REMEMBER

Emotions want to move. They become problems when they get stuck. This practice gives them permission to flow through.

# The 5-Minute Reset Protocol

## 1 Arrive (30 seconds)

Close your eyes. Take three deep breaths — in through the nose, out through the mouth. Let your body settle. Feel the surface beneath you. You're here. You're safe.

## 2 Scan (1 minute)

Slowly move your attention through your body, from head to feet. Don't try to change anything — just notice. Where is there tension? Heaviness? Numbness? Ease? *Just notice. No judgment.*

## 3 Name (30 seconds)

Pick the area calling for attention. Place your hand there if it helps. Ask: "**What is this?**" Name the sensation (tight, heavy, sharp). Then ask: "**What emotion might be here?**"

## 4 Feel (2 minutes)

This is the clearing part. Instead of pushing the feeling away, **breathe into it**. Inhale — direct your breath to that area. Exhale — imagine the emotion softening, releasing. Let sounds and movement come if they want to. **You're not analyzing. You're feeling.**

## 5 Return to Zero (1 minute)

Take three final breaths. Feel your body now — lighter, clearer, more spacious. Say silently or aloud: "**I release what isn't mine to carry. I return to zero.**" Open your eyes. You're here. You're clear.



# Quick Reference Card

Print this page and keep it where you'll see it daily.

THE 5-MINUTE RESET

1

ARRIVE (30 sec) — 3 deep breaths. Settle. You're here.

2

SCAN (1 min) — Head to feet. Notice tension, heaviness, ease.

3

NAME (30 sec) — What's the sensation? What emotion?

4

FEEL (2 min) — Breathe into it. Let it move. No resistance.

5

RETURN (1 min) — "I release what isn't mine. I return to zero."

## When to Use This Practice

| Situation                     | When to Reset                                    |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Morning routine               | Before checking your phone — start the day clear |
| Evening wind-down             | Before bed — release the day so you sleep clean  |
| After difficult conversations | Process what came up before it settles in        |
| When triggered                | As soon as you can — don't let it compound       |
| Feeling "off" for no reason   | Your body knows something — check in             |

THE COMPOUND EFFECT

Done daily, this practice prevents emotional buildup. You stop carrying yesterday into today. You stay closer to zero — that clear, grounded, present state where life flows easier.

# Ready to Go Deeper?

This guide gave you the map and the daily practice.  
The full course gives you the complete system.

## Get to Zero

*Transform Triggers Into Teachers and Finally Feel Free in Your Own Body*

6 Modules • 30 Lessons • Guided Practices • Community Support

### What You'll Learn

| Module                        | Focus                                         |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1. The Zero Point Philosophy  | Why "zero" matters and what it actually means |
| 2. The Body as Portal         | Advanced somatic awareness techniques         |
| 3. Triggers as Gifts          | Reframe what activates you into curriculum    |
| 4. The Clearing Process       | The full protocol for deep emotional release  |
| 5. Gratitude Over Forgiveness | The deeper clearing most people miss          |
| 6. Living at Zero             | Maintain your clear state in daily life       |

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# About Marilyn

I've spent my career studying human transformation — through psychology, ministry, the body, and my own lived experience.

I earned my **BS in Psychology** because I wanted to understand why we do what we do. Then I became a **grief and loss counselor**, working with families and individuals in low-income school districts and on military bases. I sat with people in their deepest pain and learned that healing isn't cognitive — it's felt.

But I was burning out. So I turned to movement — and Pilates brought me home to myself. I earned **70+ certifications** and became a master trainer, not just because I loved the work, but because I finally understood: **you can't feed others from an empty tank**.

I pursued my **MBA** to understand systems and scale. I became a **Master Restorative Health Practitioner**, specializing in holistic health that includes spiritual and emotional wellness. And I was ordained as a **minister** through **Bhava Spiritual Mission** with a specialty in counseling.

*When you commit to clearing — really clearing — everything in your life shifts.  
Relationships. Health. Purpose. All of it.*

Now I teach what I learned. The integration of **mind** (psychology), **body** (somatic awareness), and **God** (spiritual practice) — applied to the daily work of staying clear, grounded, and free.

## CREDENTIALS & TRAINING

**Education:** BS Psychology • MBA

**Ministry:** Ordained Minister, Bhava Spiritual Mission (Counseling Specialty)

**Clinical:** Grief & Loss Counselor — School Districts & Military Bases

**Holistic Health:** Master Restorative Health Practitioner

**Movement:** 70+ Fitness Certifications • Master Pilates Trainer

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